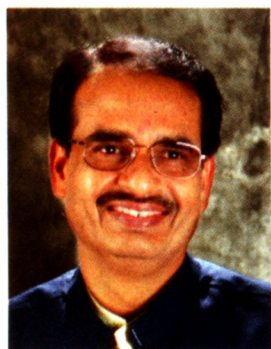




MADHYA PRADESH EMERGES AS A HIGHER EDUCATION HUB



SHRI SHIVRAJ SINGH CHOUHAN
Hon'ble Chief Minister

There have been some revolutionary changes in the field of higher education over the years. The most important change is that now higher education is a major contributor to the economy. With India striding fast to become a knowledge society higher education is no longer restricted to a handful rich and so called higher sections of society. Now it is accessible to even the poorest of the poor. With banks advancing education loan poverty is no longer a hurdle to pursue higher education.

Even more important factor is that now almost all sections of society are growing more and more aware about importance and need of quality higher education. Even middle class and lower middle class people, who used to be keen on buying houses, now prefer to invest in higher education of their children. Even children now are often heard say to their parents "We do not want you to spend lavishly in our marriage, please secure us the education we want". Besides, the returns on quality higher education are so good that the youth want to spare nothing to excel in it.

One would thus see that the youth of India is quite passionate to shine at international level by virtue of knowledge and professional skills. This can best be called a revolution in education in true sense. How can Madhya Pradesh, centrally located in the country, be intact from this revolution? In view of the above said facts, it becomes the responsibility of the state government to ensure quality education and better educational facilities to the youth. In last five years the present Madhya Pradesh government has lived up to this expectation. As a result now Madhya Pradesh is poised to emerge as a higher education hub. This is well brought out by the fact that at the Global Investors Summit held in October last at Indore MoUs were signed for twelve private universities in the state.

Action is being taken to set up a Special Education Zone (S.Ed.Z) in the form of Knowledge City at Bhopal for which 635 acre of land has already been allotted by the government. The Knowledge City would house reputed medical, engineering and other colleges on a single premises for which they would be given concessions.

An IIT has already been set up at Indore this year. A Tribal University has also come up in Shahadol. Other national institutes are coming up in the state. These include the National Institute of Fashion Technology, National Institute